Vitamin C- Deficiency



Scurvy



Pyorrhoea

Fig 11.19: Symptoms of C deficiency

Overall the body contains 2.5g to 4.0g of iron. Most of the iron in the body is found in the blood, but some is present in every cell bound to iron containing enzymes. Iron is present in Haemoglobin which contains ferrous iron. It is essential for carrying oxygen to different tissues.

Functions

- Iron is an important mineral needed for the formation of haemoglobin which is responsible for carrying oxygen from the lungs to different cells and tissues of the body in the form of oxyhaemoglobin. Thus iron helps in the oxidation process.
- It acts as a co-factor for enzymes and other proteins.
- It is required for the formation of red blood cells.

Food Sources of iron:

Haeme iron from animal foods is better absorbed than non-haeme iron present in plant sources. Liver is the best source of iron. Iron is also absorbed well from red meat like lamb. Non-haeme iron is present in cereals, millets, pulses and green leafy vegetables. Of the cereal grains, wheat and millets like bajra and ragi are very good source of iron. Inclusion of about 50g of green leafy vegetables which are rich in iron in our daily diet can help meet a fair proportion of iron needs.

Symptoms of Iron deficiency:

Iron deficiency leads to Anaemia which has the following symptoms:

- Eyes, tongue and nails become pale.
- Person feels extremely tired and fatigued.
- Decreased physical activity and breathlessness on exertion.
- Tingling sensation in fingers and toes.
- Nails become brittle and become concave and appear like a spoon.
- Loss of appetite and giddiness.
- Poor coordination of body functions.

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